

DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT

Reciprocal Stabilization and Custody Framework

*A Mutual De-escalation Protocol for the United States
and the Islamic Republic of Iran*

Ad referendum — For Authorized Negotiators

Drafted: 15 May 2026

Effective upon exchange of instruments

Day 1 at a glance: Iran's stockpile enters IAEA custody; the U.S. releases \$250 million and eases maritime enforcement. Both moves activate simultaneously. Neither side moves alone.

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Political Preamble

Purpose and Scope

This **Reciprocal Stabilization and Custody Framework** (hereinafter "the Framework") is a crisis instrument concluded between the United States of America and the Islamic Republic of Iran (hereinafter "the Parties"). It is designed to arrest nuclear escalation, remove high-risk enrichment material from immediate reach, and create verified, reciprocal constraints that neither side can exploit for unilateral advantage.

The Framework is *not* a comprehensive peace treaty. It addresses one urgent problem: the presence of a highly enriched uranium stockpile on Iranian territory at a moment when military escalation remains live. By converting that stockpile into a verified custodial asset held by a neutral third party, and by pairing that conversion with immediate, visible, and reciprocal U.S. concessions, the Framework creates a de-escalation equilibrium that both Parties can defend domestically.

Mutual Non-Humiliation Clause — Operative and Binding

Neither Party shall publicly characterize Framework implementation as surrender, capitulation, defeat, or coercive submission by the other Party. This prohibition applies to all forms of public messaging, official talking points, diplomatic communications, implementation readouts, and statements to domestic or international media. Both Parties undertake to describe the Framework as a reciprocal stabilization instrument in which each side gains commensurate benefits. This clause is enforceable through the Joint Coordination Secretariat and constitutes a Tier 1 breach if deliberately violated.

No Regime Change Intent — Operative and Binding

This Framework shall not be interpreted as authorizing, supporting, or condoning forcible regime change, territorial fragmentation, unconstitutional political overthrow, covert destabilization operations, or economic strangulation designed to precipitate governmental collapse in either Party. Both Parties affirm that this instrument is confined to nuclear stabilization and maritime de-escalation and creates no license for broader political interference.

The central design principle is simple: neither side moves alone. Every Iranian commitment is matched by a simultaneous U.S. commitment of equal political weight. Symmetry is not an aesthetic preference; it is the structural feature that makes the Framework durable.

Sequencing Hierarchy

This Framework proceeds in three sequential phases, each distinct in purpose and timing. **Political commitment first:** Day-One activation establishes the core reciprocal trade and is irrevocable upon signature. **Physical verification second:** IAEA inventory, sealing, and packaging preparation occur during Days 1–7; transit initiation and batch movement occur during Days 7–14; the Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate confirms what was done. **Staged relief third:** deeper sanctions relief and expanded obligations activate only after the Gate is cleared, with each tranche verified before the next releases.

The May 2026 Moment

As of 15 May 2026, the United States and Iran stand closer to renewed military confrontation than at any point since the February 2026 strikes. A temporary ceasefire, brokered by Pakistan and observed since early April, remains technically in force but is fraying. U.S. naval forces maintain a close-proximity maritime enforcement posture on Iranian commercial shipping. Iranian forces continue to restrict transit through the Strait of Hormuz. Gasoline prices in the United States impose acute domestic political pressure. Iran's economy faces catastrophic damage from the dual interdiction configuration.

Within this compressed window, both Parties have signaled conditional interest in a narrow, verifiable arrangement that addresses the enriched-uranium stockpile without requiring either side to surrender its core negotiating position for a future comprehensive agreement. This Framework captures that conditional interest and converts it into binding operational language.

Core Principles

Principle 1: Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

Neither Party undertakes any obligation without a simultaneous, corresponding obligation from the other Party. Obligations are paired, not sequential. Verification is shared, not unilateral.

Principle 2: Neutral Custody, Not Surrender

The transfer of enriched uranium from Iran to third-party custody is a neutral custodial arrangement under IAEA oversight. Iran does not "surrender" its material to the United States; it places it in international trust. Sovereign title remains with Iran.

Principle 3: Front-Loaded Reciprocity

The U.S. receives its most visible win on Day 1: the high-risk enrichment stockpile leaves Iranian territory. Iran receives its most visible win on Day 1: maritime pressure eases, humanitarian channels open, and a formal U.S. statement acknowledges Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under monitored, non-weapon pathways.

Principle 4: Crisis Instrument, Not Precedent

This Framework creates no legal or political precedent for future negotiations. Each provision is *sui generis*, tailored to May 2026. No inference may be drawn from any provision regarding positions on any matter not expressly addressed herein.

Principle 5: Rollback, Not Snapback

If either Party breaches, the Framework does not collapse. It pauses in graduated tiers: discretionary measures halt first, core constraints survive longest, and humanitarian protections remain in force regardless.

Document Structure

Part	Content	Binding Character
Political Preamble	Context, principles, mutual assurances	Politically binding
Operational Memorandum (5 Points)	Reciprocal obligations, timeline, conditionality	Legally binding upon acceptance
Technical Annex (7 Annexes)	Verification, custody, monitoring, rollback, crisis, institutions, digest	Integral; binding in full
Confidential Implementation Annexes	Operational details, deconfliction maps, intelligence protections (see Point 5.7)	Restricted to designated authorities

Part I: Operational Memorandum

IMPLEMENTATION TIMELINE LEGEND

Phase	Period	What It Controls
Activation	Day 1 (72-hour window)	Core reciprocal exchange: stockpile transfer initiates; U.S. humanitarian and maritime relief activates simultaneously. Throughout this Framework, "Day 1" means the 72-hour window beginning at Framework entry into force.
Verification	Days 1–14 (Stabilization Gate)	Three primary channels certify that Day-One commitments were performed in good faith and in substance
Implementation	Days 14–180 (Tranches 2a through 7)	Progressive reciprocal obligations deepen in measured stages, each verified before the next activates

Cascade Safeguard: Slippage in one milestone does not automatically collapse later milestones. Each obligation stands on its own verification trigger unless expressly linked.

Priority of Clocks: Day-One activation controls the political trade. The Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate controls verification. Later dates control staged relief. If any timing conflict arises, the Day-One exchange takes precedence over all subsequent timelines. The Secretariat publishes one authoritative schedule if timing language conflicts.

The Core Trade

DAY-ONE BILATERAL EXCHANGE — THE CORE TRADE

Both moves activate simultaneously on Day 1. Neither side moves alone.

Iran Transfers to IAEA Custody	U.S. Activates Simultaneously
Entire 60% HEU stockpile consolidated, sealed, and placed in IAEA custody for transfer to Oman (preferred) or Kazakhstan (fallback)	USD 250 million humanitarian tranche credited via Swiss escrow
IAEA inspectors given immediate access to declared storage sites	OFAC general license for humanitarian trade (medicine, food, medical equipment, aviation safety) for 90 days

Iranian observer team accompanies packaging and transit	U.S. naval forces transition to stand-off posture (no patrols within 5 nm of Hormuz transit corridor)
Enrichment above 3.67% U-235 ceases from Day 1 forward	Written commitment: no new sanctions designations for Framework duration
Formal notification to Joint Coordination Secretariat confirming transfer initiation	Formal statement acknowledging Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV; published simultaneously by both capitals

Both moves activate simultaneously and are not contingent on later political declarations. The only contingency is mechanical: both Parties activate within the 72-hour window.

Why this is safe for Iran: The stockpile goes to third-party custody under IAEA control, not to the United States. Oman is the preferred facilitating state; Kazakhstan is the designated fallback. The IAEA controls the facility. Sovereign title stays Iranian. The transfer is custodial, not proprietary. Iran retains observer rights at every stage. Final disposition is deferred to a later agreement.

No Hidden U.S. Custody Clause — Operative and Binding

At no stage may the United States receive, store, transport, or exercise operational control over the Iranian enriched-uranium stockpile. All custody remains with the IAEA and the designated third-party facilitating state. U.S. personnel shall not be present at any consolidation, packaging, transit, or receipt operation. This clause is self-executing and non-waivable.

No Automatic Military Authorization Clause — Operative and Binding

No breach determination, rollback classification, or compliance failure under this Framework shall constitute authorization, implied permission, or legal basis for the use of military force by either Party. Dispute resolution shall proceed exclusively through the mechanisms specified in Annex E. This clause is self-executing and may not be overridden by any interpretation of breach consequences.

Both moves activate simultaneously and are not contingent on later political declarations, parliamentary ratifications, or external events. The only contingency is mechanical: both Parties must activate on Day 1. Either Party's failure triggers automatic abeyance pending Secretariat assessment.

Domestic Narrative Provisions and Parallel Claims

Iranian domestic narrative: The transfer of enriched uranium is to neutral IAEA custody under the supervision of a third-party facilitating state. Sovereign title remains with Iran. The United States is explicitly barred from ever controlling the material. The Framework contains a binding No Regime Change Intent

clause and a Mutual Non-Humiliation clause. Iran retains full enrichment rights at 3.67% under NPT Article IV, acknowledged in writing by the United States. This is a 12-month stabilization instrument, renewable annually — not a comprehensive settlement, not permanent surrender, and not a concession of Iran's nuclear rights.

U.S. domestic narrative: The entire stockpile of high-risk enriched uranium leaves Iranian territory on Day 1 and is placed under IAEA control in Oman. The enrichment cap of 3.67% is verified daily by IAEA inspectors on Iranian soil. No new centrifuges may be installed at any facility, including hardened underground sites. Every U.S. concession is matched by a simultaneous, verified Iranian concession. The Framework creates a 12-month verified compliance baseline with 90+ day warning for any breakout attempt. This is a crisis stabilization instrument that protects U.S. security interests without authorizing military action.

WHAT IRAN CAN CLAIM	WHAT THE U.S. CAN CLAIM
• "The close-proximity maritime enforcement posture was eased on Day 1. Iranian ports are open." • "We transferred material to IAEA custody, not to the United States. Sovereign title remains Iranian." • "The United States formally acknowledged our sovereign nuclear rights under NPT Article IV." • "Enrichment continues at Natanz at 3.67% under IAEA monitoring, not U.S. surveillance." • "This is a 12-month stabilization window, not permanent surrender. We review annually."	• "60% enriched uranium left Iran on Day 1 and is in IAEA custody in Oman." • "Enrichment above 3.67% is frozen. The cap is verified by IAEA inspectors on Iranian soil." • "No new centrifuges at any facility, including hardened underground sites." • "Every U.S. concession was matched by a simultaneous Iranian concession. Nothing was given away." • "This creates 12 months of verified compliance to negotiate a comprehensive deal."

Point 1 — The Reciprocal Day-One Exchange

1.1 Core Day-One Commitments

Only the following five commitments activate on Day 1. All other obligations follow in Days 3–5 administrative windows.

Iran Delivers (on Day 1)	U.S. Delivers (simultaneously, on Day 1)
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Entire 60% HEU stockpile consolidated and placed in IAEA custody for transfer to the designated third-party facility	USD 250 million humanitarian tranche credited via Swiss escrow
IAEA inspectors given immediate access to declared storage sites for consolidation	OFAC general license for humanitarian trade (medicine, food, medical equipment, aviation safety parts) for 90 days
Iranian observer team deployed to accompany packaging and transit	U.S. naval forces transition to stand-off posture: no patrols within 5 nm of Hormuz transit corridor
No enrichment above 3.67% U-235 from Day 1 forward	Written commitment: no new sanctions designations for Framework duration
Formal notification to Joint Coordination Secretariat confirming transfer initiation	Formal statement acknowledging Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV through monitored, non-weapon pathways; published simultaneously by both capitals

1.2 Days 3–5 Administrative Execution

Administrative and technical obligations that do not require immediate activation shall execute in the Days 3–5 window:

Timing	Iranian Obligation	U.S. Obligation
Day 3–5	Complete physical inventory documentation; finalize chain-of-custody manifest; deploy full transit escort team	Publish sovereign-rights statement in Federal Register; activate escrow routing protocols; notify 5th Fleet of posture adjustment
Day 3–5	Transmit consolidated stockpile data to IAEA Transparency Portal	Confirm humanitarian channel operational status to Swiss escrow agent and Joint Coordination Secretariat

1.3 Custody Destination

Priority	Facilitating State	Facility	Transit Time
Preferred	Sultanate of Oman	Oman Nuclear Custody Facility (ONCF)	4–10 days
Designated Fallback	Republic of Kazakhstan	IAEA LEU Bank, Oskemen	45–75 days

1.4 Chain-of-Custody Timeline

Phase	Period	Action	Verifying Party
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Activation	Day 1 (72-hour window)	Framework activates; Parties activate Day-One political commitments; IAEA inspectors arrive at Esfahan	Joint Coordination Secretariat
Inventory	Days 1–7	Physical inventory; mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition; cylinders loaded into casks; tamper-evident seals applied	IAEA
Transit	Days 7–14	Convoy departs under IAEA armed escort; GPS tracking activated; transit initiation verified	IAEA + Omani Navy
Gate	By Day 14 (or shortly after with extension)	Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate certification; Facilitator extension authority available for genuine logistical delays	Three Primary Channels
Relief	After Gate cleared	Staged relief and deeper obligations activate progressively, each verified before the next	Joint Coordination Secretariat

1.5 Non-Contingency Binding

The Day-One Exchange is irrevocably committed upon Framework signature. Neither Party may condition its performance on: subsequent political declarations; ceasefire formalization or Hormuz reopening; prisoner exchange; third-party certification outside the Day-One protocol; or changes in regional circumstances including proxy-force activity by non-Party actors. The only grounds for delay are operational incapacity (natural disaster, cyber attack, force majeure), in which case the Secretariat may extend the 72-hour window by up to 48 hours with written justification.

Point 2 — The Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate

2.1 What "Certified" Means — Three Primary Channels

The Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate — Verification Only

This Gate is a verification window, not a delay in the underlying commitment. The Day-One exchange activates within 72 hours regardless of certification status. The Gate simply confirms that what both Parties promised on Day 1 was actually performed. It cannot be used to suspend, reverse, or condition the Day-One exchange. Certification requires that **each of the three primary verification channels** issue a positive written certification by 2400 GMT on Day 14. Two secondary advisory channels provide political and procedural confirmation but do not hold blocking authority.

Channel	Status	Certifying Authority	What Must Be Certified
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Channel 1: Nuclear Verification	Primary	IAEA Director-General or designated senior inspector	Channel 1 certifies: (a) all 60% HEU cylinders consolidated, sealed, and in transit or arrived at custody facility; (b) mass spectrometry confirms declared isotopic composition; (c) chain-of-custody documentation complete and signed by IAEA, Iranian AEIOI, and host-state representatives
Channel 2: Maritime Observation	Primary	Omani Maritime Operations Cell	Channel 2 certifies: (a) U.S. vessels at stand-off posture (no patrols within 5 nm); (b) Iranian naval craft withdrawn to 5 nm from central corridor; (c) zero interdiction incidents Days 1–14
Channel 3: Financial Confirmation	Primary	Swiss escrow agent	Channel 3 certifies: (a) USD 250 million credited to Iranian Central Bank humanitarian account; (b) transaction settled and irrevocable; (c) humanitarian OFAC license issued and in force
Channel 4: Political Facilitation	Advisory	Pakistani Prime Minister's Office (supporting facilitator)	Channel 4 confirms: Both Parties activated Day-One commitments in good faith; no Party invoked operational-incapacity extension
Channel 5: Procedural Registration	Advisory	UN Secretary-General	Channel 5 confirms: Framework entry into force registered; Day-One instruments deposited; no procedural objections filed

2.2 Channel Silence Protocol

If any primary channel has not issued written certification by the Day 14 deadline: the Secretariat first convenes a 48-hour Operational Consultation Window, allowing facilitators to discuss technical delays privately before any official flagging. If the deficiency remains after 48 hours, the Secretariat issues a Channel Silence Notice. The silent channel then has 72 hours to certify or explain. Late certification is accepted without penalty. Non-certification after 72 hours triggers non-certification, but Day-One commitments survive.

2.3 Ambiguity Dispute Rule

If verification data is ambiguous: escalation is paused; Day-One commitments already performed are *not* paused; the VIU protocol activates (Annex A.2); hard 60-day ceiling applies.

2.4 Logistical Transit Buffer

A 72-hour Logistical Buffer applies **only to transit initiation** and may be invoked when multiple states require additional time to coordinate. If technical issues arise with transport casks, mass spectrometry equipment, or chain-of-custody documentation during the T+48h to T+72h window, the IAEA may invoke the buffer by written notice to the Secretariat. The buffer extends the transit-initiation deadline by 72 hours without triggering automatic abeyance. The buffer is available once per Party per Framework cycle and may be invoked for: cask recertification; mass spectrometer recalibration; seal documentation discrepancies; or

adverse weather affecting convoy departure. The buffer does not apply to the broader Day-One exchange, does not extend the overall Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate, and shifts only the transit-initiation milestone within it.

Ambiguity pauses the future; it does not undo the past.

Point 3 — The Enrichment Moratorium Window

3.1 Three Distinct Obligations

Obligation	Definition	Technical Meaning	U.S. Reciprocal Commitment
Cap	Maximum permissible enrichment level	No enrichment above 3.67% U-235 at any facility at any time	Tranche 2a (Day 14): Petrochemicals and oil-services trade licenses, plus civilian aviation safety authorizations upon clearing the Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate
Freeze	Cessation of specific activities already occurring	All cascades configured for enrichment above 3.67% idled; UF6 feedstock removed and IAEA-sealed; no restart without 30 days' notice; 7-day Administrative Power-Down permitted (see 3.5)	Tranche 2b (Day 45): 25% of frozen assets released upon IAEA confirmation of freeze completion
No New Installation	Prohibition on adding new hardware	Zero new centrifuges installed at any facility, including designated hardened enrichment facilities; zero new enrichment-related infrastructure constructed	Tranche 4 (Day 90): SWIFT reconnection process commenced

3.5 Soft-Start: Administrative Power-Down Period

Following certification of the Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate, Iran shall have a 7-day Administrative Power-Down period before the full moratorium obligations take effect. During this window:

- Technicians may safely idle cascades configured for enrichment above 3.67% without risk of equipment damage from rushed shutdown
- UF6 feedstock may be progressively removed from cascade headers and placed under IAEA seal at a rate consistent with safe operational practice
- Facility staff may complete administrative logging and transition to monitoring-mode protocols
- IAEA inspectors shall observe but not interrupt the power-down process unless enrichment above 3.67% continues beyond Day 7 of the power-down

The Administrative Power-Down is **explicitly non-prejudicial to compliance**. No inference of non-compliance may be drawn from activity observed during the 7-day power-down window. IAEA inspectors shall observe and document but shall not issue any Non-Compliance Notice based solely on enrichment activity during this window. The power-down does not delay U.S. reciprocal commitments. Tranche 2a (Day 14) releases upon Gate certification regardless of power-down status. The power-down is a safety and implementation buffer, not a compliance extension.

3.2 Why Twelve Months

The initial moratorium of twelve months is a **stabilization window**. Politically, it bridges one full U.S. electoral cycle and one Iranian parliamentary session, giving both governments time to demonstrate benefits before re-election pressure. Technically, twelve months of verified compliance establishes a credible baseline making any future breakout detectable with 90+ days' warning. Diplomatically, it creates the trust interval for successor negotiation. The moratorium is renewable precisely because twelve months is a test, not a surrender.

3.3 Monitoring Sunset Tiers

To reduce sovereignty concerns, intrusive monitoring technologies are subject to graduated sunset:

Monitoring Measure	Initial Intensity	Sunset Reduction	Condition for Reduction
Seismic sensors at designated hardened enrichment facilities	Continuous	Reduced to weekly sampling after 12 months of clean compliance	12 consecutive months of IAEA-certified compliance with the cap and freeze obligations
Enhanced satellite revisit frequency	Daily	Reduced to 3x weekly after 18 months	18 consecutive months of clean compliance
Unannounced inspection frequency	20% of all inspections for the first 90 days; increasing to minimum 33% thereafter	Reduced to 20% after 24 months	24 consecutive months of clean compliance; standard IAEA Additional Protocol applies thereafter
Continuous camera monitoring	24/7 encrypted	No sunset; standard for all NPT Additional Protocol states	Baseline protection; never reduced

3.4 Domestic Narrative Provisions

See Domestic Narrative Provisions and Parallel Claims, placed immediately following the Core Trade for political accessibility.

Point 4 — Staged Sanctions Relief

Tranche	Timing	Value / Scope	Verification Trigger
Pilot	Day 1	USD 250 million + humanitarian OFAC license	Framework signature
Tranche 2a	Day 14	Petrochemicals; oil services; sectoral trade licenses; civilian aviation safety authorizations	Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate certified
Tranche 2b	Day 45	Expanded petrochemical trade access; commercial insurance facility access	IAEA confirms 3.67% cap sustained
Tranche 3	Day 60	25% of frozen assets released	IAEA confirms high-enrichment freeze
Tranche 4	Day 90	SWIFT reconnection for FATF-compliant banks	IAEA confirms zero new centrifuge installation
Tranche 5	Day 120	Expanded trade authorizations; commercial insurance access	Quarterly review passed
Tranche 6	Day 150	Banking normalization for Tier 1 institutions	Semi-annual review passed
Tranche 7	Day 180	Technology transfer licenses; advanced civilian equipment	Full six-month compliance certified
Final	Year 1+	Progressive normalization per agreed schedule	Annual review and renewal consent

Initial tranches (Pilot through Tranche 3) are non-reversible upon transfer, matching the irreversibility of Iran's Day-One stockpile transfer and enrichment cap. The PRDD Snap Line (Annex B.4) provides automatic escrow suspension within 72 hours of an IAEA Tier 1 Non-Compliance Notice.

Point 5 — Safeguards, Rollback, and Institutional Architecture

5.1 No-Precedent Clause

"This Framework establishes no legal or political precedent for future negotiations. Each provision is sui generis, tailored to the May 2026 crisis environment. No inference may be drawn from any provision regarding positions on any matter not expressly addressed herein."

5.2 Tiered Rollback — One Trigger, One Remedy, One Surviving Right Per Tier

Tier	Concrete Trigger	Concrete Remedy	Concrete Surviving Right
Tier 1	Single data-point anomaly; reporting deadline missed by <48h; one centrifuge offline but no enrichment above 3.67% detected	14-day remediation; enhanced inspection of specific item; daily reporting until cleared; no relief suspension	All sanctions relief continues. All enrichment constraints remain. Humanitarian channel uninterrupted.
Tier 2	IAEA confirms enrichment above 3.67%; unauthorized centrifuge installation; UF6 diversion to undeclared location confirmed through corroborated multi-source verification	Discretionary relief (Tranches 5–7) suspended; PRDD Snap Line activated; 60-day remediation; daily unannounced inspections	Humanitarian channel continues. Enrichment cap survives. IAEA monitoring survives. Ceasefire hotline active.
Tier 3	Weaponization activity confirmed by IAEA <i>plus</i> two independent technical sources <i>plus</i> Secretariat review; sustained non-compliance after Tier 2 remediation expires	Full rollback; pending escrow releases frozen and returned; pre-Framework sanctions posture resumes; naval posture returns to pre-Day-1 configuration; Reconstitution Conference convened within 30 days	Humanitarian corridor continues under UN mandate. NPT safeguards remain. Ceasefire hotline active 180 days. Custodial stockpile remains under IAEA control — not returned to Iran absent new agreement.

5.3 Framework Survival Core

Under all circumstances: (1) the Omani-facilitated ceasefire hotline remains active; (2) the humanitarian corridor through Hormuz continues; (3) the emergency diplomatic channel stays open.

5.4 Political Shock Absorber

Elections, leadership transitions, or cabinet collapse trigger a 90-day Review Pause. Core obligations continue; discretionary measures may be deferred without breach.

5.5 No Silent Delay Clause

The Secretariat issues a written Delay Notice within 24 hours of any missed milestone, specifying the milestone, responsible Party, cause, revised date, and rollback tier triggered. Secretariat silence does not excuse delay.

5.6 Administrative Delay Safe Harbor and Technical Grace Periods

Administrative delays: Clerical delays not materially affecting compliance shall not constitute breach. Examples include: delayed signature due to weekend protocols; filing-format corrections; translation

verification; notarization scheduling. The affected Party must notify the Secretariat within 48 hours and provide an expected cure date. Delays exceeding 14 days require written justification.

Technical Grace Periods: Non-material technical anomalies shall not constitute breach if resolved within 96 hours. A technical anomaly is "non-material" if it does not affect the substance of the obligation. Examples include: a single sensor going offline with redundant sensors operational; a GPS tracking stutter with convoy position confirmed by independent means; a data-transmission delay with physical inspection available as backup. The affected Party must notify the Secretariat within 12 hours of discovering the anomaly, describe the technical cause, confirm that redundant systems are operational, and provide an expected resolution timeline. The 96-hour grace period begins at notification. If the anomaly is not resolved within 96 hours, it is reclassified as a Tier 1 technical dispute. If the anomaly is resolved within 96 hours, no breach record is created and no compliance score is affected.

5.7 Limited Confidential Annexes

Certain operational details may be maintained in confidential implementation annexes shared only among designated authorities. These may include: detailed facility access protocols; naval deconfliction maps; intelligence-sharing parameters; and technical specifications requiring security clearance. Confidential annexes are binding on their signatories but are not published to the Transparency Portal. Each Party may designate up to five authorized representatives with access.

5.8 Media Cooling-Off Understanding

During active remediation periods and Stabilization Holds, both Parties shall refrain from public accusations prejudging verification outcomes. Public statements shall be limited to: confirmation that the Framework remains in force; reference to the relevant rollback tier; and commitment to Secretariat procedures. This provision is advisory, not enforceable through rollback, but either Party may invoke it as a procedural complaint.

5.9 Framework Conversion Path

At Month 9, either Party may request exploratory discussions regarding successor arrangements without obligation. Such discussions do not commit either Party to any extension, modification, or comprehensive agreement. The sole purpose is to assess whether conditions support a broader negotiation. If both Parties agree, discussions convene within 30 days under the auspices of the Designated Facilitating States. Declining to participate in exploratory discussions does not constitute breach.

5.10 Facilitator Discretion — Joint Technical Extension Authority

The Designated Facilitating States (Oman and Switzerland) are jointly authorized to issue a 10-day Technical Extension to any Framework milestone if they determine, by mutual written agreement, that:

- Both Parties are acting in good faith and making demonstrable efforts to meet the milestone
- The delay is caused by genuine logistical hurdles (weather, equipment failure, customs processing, transit restrictions) rather than political resistance or deliberate non-compliance

- The extension does not materially alter the Framework's security architecture or the core exchange balance
- Both Parties have been consulted and neither objects within 24 hours of the extension proposal

A Technical Extension covers genuine shipping, sealing, routing, or inspection delays. It may **not** be used to reopen, renegotiate, or condition the core political exchange. A Technical Extension may be issued once per milestone per Framework cycle. It does not extend the overall Framework duration or renewal deadline. It does not trigger any rollback tier. It does not affect the non-reversibility of tranches already released. The Secretariat records the extension in the Transparency Portal within 6 hours of issuance.

5.11 Facilitator Support Provisions

The Designated Facilitating States (Oman and Kazakhstan) shall receive: inspection-cost reimbursement from the IAEA Enhanced Monitoring Fund; maritime infrastructure support for custody-facility operations; and explicit sanctions shielding ensuring that facilitation activities under this Framework do not expose either state to U.S., EU, or third-party sanctions. These provisions are self-executing upon Framework entry into force.

5.11 Domestic Institutional Consultation

Both Parties affirm the importance of consultation with their constitutional institutions consistent with domestic law. The United States shall provide Congressional notification under the Iran Nuclear Agreement Review Act. Iran shall provide Majlis notification with a 15-day period for constitutional objection. Absence of objection constitutes implicit authorization. Neither consultation requirement is a veto point; Framework obligations are executive in character and do not require legislative ratification.

Part II: Technical Annex

Annex A: Verification Architecture

A.1 Multi-Source Verification

No compliance determination relies on a single source. Assessment requires corroboration across: automated sensor data (IAEA, dual-transmission to Vienna and Geneva); independent sampling and physical inspection; redundant measurement cross-checks; and air-gapped audit records. No single compromised system triggers consequences.

A.2 VIU Protocol

Verification data ambiguity activates the "Verification Integrity Uncertain" (VIU) status: escalation paused; Day-One commitments performed remain in force; IAEA re-verification within 48 hours; hard 60-day ceiling; status-quo default outcome if unresolved.

A.3 Inspection Scope

IAEA access applies to **sites identified through corroborated multi-source verification procedures** under this Annex. Access to sensitive sites is coordinated through Iran's Supreme National Security Council. Iran shall accept at least one verification method per request. A single denial does not constitute compliance concern; a sustained pattern triggers Secretariat review.

Annex B: Stockpile Custody Protocol

B.1 Custody Chain

1. **Consolidation:** 60% HEU cylinders transported to Esfahan for IAEA-supervised inventory.
2. **Verification:** Mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition. Consolidation Inventory Certificate issued. *Staged batches (approved method):* If logistics or security require it, the stockpile may be consolidated, sealed, and certified in multiple batches. This is an approved implementation method, not a fallback excuse or a separate legal standard. Each batch receives its own Consolidation Inventory Certificate and independent chain-of-custody documentation.
3. **Packaging:** Cylinders loaded into IAEA-certified Type B(U) casks with serialized tamper-evident seals.
4. **Transit:** Dedicated convoy under IAEA armed escort with GPS tracking. *Batch transit permitted:* Casks may depart in multiple convoys if a single convoy exceeds safe-load limits or if route security requires distribution. Each convoy has independent GPS tracking and IAEA escort.
5. **Receipt:** Casks unsealed in presence of IAEA rep, host-state director, and Iranian AEOI observer.
6. **Custody transfer:** IAEA assumes operational custody. Custody Transfer Certificate triggers Tranche 3. *IAEA may certify by batch:* The IAEA shall issue a Partial Custody Receipt for each batch received, with a Final Custody Certificate issued upon receipt of all batches. Partial receipts count toward the

Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate; the Gate is not held open pending the last batch unless the Secretariat determines that batch separation constitutes deliberate delay.

B.1a Transit and Calibration Delay Reporting

Any calibration delay, transit interruption, cask recertification requirement, or mass spectrometer recalibration must be reported to the Joint Coordination Secretariat within 24 hours of discovery. The report must include: the nature of the delay; the affected batch number (if applicable); the expected resolution timeline; and confirmation that the material remains under IAEA seal and armed escort during the delay. Failure to report within 24 hours converts a technical delay into an Administrative Delay Safe Harbor notification under Point 5.6.

B.2 Custody Maintenance

IAEA permanent monitoring with host-state perimeter security. Iranian observer access maintained. 24/7 camera coverage, environmental sampling, unannounced inspections. Costs borne by IAEA Enhanced Monitoring Fund.

B.3 Final Disposition

Determined by separate agreement no earlier than 12 months from entry into force. Until then, material remains in IAEA custody with both Parties having observer access.

Annex C: Monitoring Technology Menu

Technology	Deployment	Function	Sunset
Dual-key encrypted cameras	Esfahan, Fordow, Natanz, hardened enrichment facilities	24/7 encrypted feeds to Vienna + Geneva	None (standard NPT AP)
Tamper-evident seals	All UF6 cylinders, feed lines, storage vessels	Serialized; breach triggers immediate alert	None
Real-time mass-flow verification	Esfahan blending cascade	Continuous rate monitoring	None
Environmental sampling	All declared sites; 8/quarter/site	Independent isotopic verification	None
Seismic sensors	Hardened enrichment facility access points	Detects underground centrifuge operation	Weekly after 12 months clean
GPS tracking	All transport convoys and vessels	Real-time position to Transparency Portal	None
Air-gapped audit logs	IAEA records	Tamper-resistant archive	None

Annex D: Tiered Rollback Architecture

D.0 Definitions — Delay and Breach Classifications

Administrative delay: A delay caused by procedural, clerical, translation, scheduling, or notarization factors that does not affect the physical substance of the obligation. Examples: weekend signature protocols; filing-format corrections; translation verification; notarization scheduling. Remedy: notify Secretariat within 48 hours; provide expected cure date. No breach if cured within 14 days.

Technical delay: A delay caused by equipment malfunction, calibration requirements, sensor maintenance, transit disruption due to weather, or cask recertification that temporarily impedes verification but does not alter the substantive status of the obligation. Remedy: notify Secretariat within 24 hours; 96-hour Technical Grace Period applies (Point 5.6). No breach if resolved within grace period.

Material breach: A failure that affects the substantive core of the obligation: enrichment above the 3.67% cap continues after the power-down period; stockpile is not placed in IAEA custody within the 72-hour window plus applicable buffers; new centrifuges are installed; or UF₆ is diverted to an undeclared location confirmed by corroborated multi-source verification. Material breach triggers Tier 2 or Tier 3 rollback.

D.1 Principles

Proportionality: response matches severity. Graduation: each tier preserves more than it removes. Reversibility: suspended benefits are earn-backable through verified compliance. **Completed milestones are protected:** a delay in one step does not disturb the legal status of already-completed steps or already-released benefits. Tranches delivered and obligations performed remain in force regardless of subsequent slippage elsewhere.

D.2 Earn-Back

A Party correcting a Tier 1 or Tier 2 breach may petition for earn-back. Secretariat convenes within 14 days. If IAEA confirms 60 days of sustained compliance post-correction, suspended tranches restore progressively.

D.3 Humanitarian Firewall

Medical, food, and isotope funds and channels are protected from all rollback regardless of breach tier. Civilian populations shall not bear the cost of governmental disputes.

Annex E: Crisis and Dispute Resolution

E.1 De-escalation Interval

Minor spoiler events: Unclear attribution triggers a 24–72 hour Cooling-Off Period. No escalatory action permitted. Self-defense against active armed attack permitted; retaliatory strikes prohibited pending attribution.

Serious and Critical spoiler events: A mandatory 5-day De-escalation Interval applies. During this interval: no Party may take military action against the other; no Party may suspend Framework obligations; the Secretariat convenes within 24 hours; Designated Facilitating States engage both Parties within 48 hours; and a structured assessment of the spoiler event's impact on Framework assumptions is completed by Day 5. The De-escalation Interval may be extended by mutual consent or by joint recommendation of the Designated Facilitating States. Self-defense against ongoing active armed attack is permitted during the interval, but retaliatory strikes against the other Party's territory or facilities are prohibited until the interval concludes or the Secretariat determines that the attack constitutes independent self-defense unrelated to Framework disputes.

E.2 Spoiler Events

Category	Definition	Default Response
Minor	Localized, limited-duration incident	Information exchange; optional Secretariat meeting; no automatic hold
Serious	Sustained incident with measurable regional impact	Secretariat convenes within 5 days; 30–60 day Stabilization Hold
Critical	Major escalation threatening Framework assumptions	Emergency convening within 24 hours; extended Stabilization Hold up to 120 days

E.3 Dispute Resolution Ladder

1. Bilateral consultation through Designated Facilitating States (14 days)
2. Joint Coordination Secretariat technical review (14 days)
3. Designated Facilitating States mediation (14 days)
4. UN Secretary-General good offices (discretionary)

Annex F: Institutional Framework

F.1 Joint Coordination Secretariat

Headquartered in Geneva with a maritime desk in Muscat. Six cells: Political Coordination, Maritime Operations, Nuclear Verification, Financial Operations, Communications, Crisis Response. Rotating facilitation quarterly among Oman, Switzerland, and Qatar. Rotating facilitator has convening and procedural authority, no substantive voting power.

F.2 Designated Facilitating States

State	Domain	Function
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Oman	Maritime / Political	Hotline management; naval deconfliction; Hormuz transit oversight; primary political relay
Switzerland	Financial	Escrow administration; asset verification; sanctions relief monitoring
Pakistan	Supporting Facilitator	High-level crisis summits; backchannel facilitation; emergency convening (advisory, not mandatory certifier)
Qatar	Liquidity	Emergency liquidity facility; bridging finance; humanitarian corridor support

F.3 IAEA Role

Independent nuclear verification authority. Twelve resident inspectors monthly at declared sites. Unannounced inspections begin at 20% of total inspection events for the first 90 days, graduating to 33% upon joint certification of ambient stability by the Three Primary Channels. Daily satellite surveillance. Real-time data nodes in Vienna (primary) and Geneva (secondary). Findings transmitted simultaneously to both Parties and the Secretariat.

F.4 Transparency Portal

Secure portal providing real-time data on: implementation status; compliance scores; asset tracking; transit verification; spoiler monitoring. Both Parties have equal access. Data filtered at source to protect industrial secrets.

Annex G: One-Page Executive Digest

CRISIS STABILIZATION INSTRUMENT — NOT A COMPREHENSIVE SETTLEMENT

Reciprocal Stabilization and Custody Framework — May 2026

This Framework is a stabilization instrument designed to arrest escalation and create space for comprehensive negotiation. It resolves one urgent problem — the high-risk enriched uranium stockpile — and creates a 12-month verified equilibrium. Nothing more. Nothing less.

What Iran does on Day 1: Initiates the verified transfer of its entire 60% enriched uranium stockpile into IAEA custody at the Oman Nuclear Custody Facility (Kazakhstan as fallback). Iranian observers accompany every stage. Sovereign title remains Iranian. The Framework explicitly bars the United States from ever receiving, storing, or exercising operational control over the material (Point 1.3, No Hidden U.S. Custody Clause).

What the U.S. does simultaneously on Day 1: Releases USD 250 million via Swiss escrow. Transitions U.S. naval forces to stand-off posture (no patrols within 5 nm of Hormuz). Issues an OFAC general license for humanitarian trade. Freezes all new sanctions. Issues a formal statement acknowledging Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV. Both statements are published simultaneously by both capitals.

Why this is safe for Iran: The stockpile goes to neutral third-party custody under IAEA control — not to the United States. Sovereign title stays Iranian. The transfer is custodial, not proprietary. It is a 12-month stabilization window, renewable annually, not permanent surrender. The Framework contains an explicit No Regime Change Intent clause and a binding Mutual Non-Humiliation clause. Confidential annexes protect sensitive details.

Why this works for the U.S.: High-risk enriched uranium leaves Iranian territory on Day 1, verified by IAEA inspectors. Enrichment above 3.67% is capped. No new centrifuges at any facility. Every U.S. concession is matched by a simultaneous, verified Iranian concession. No hidden veto triggers. No automatic military authorization. Breach does not equal war.

How compliance is verified: Three primary channels certify by Day 14 (or shortly after with extension): IAEA certifies stockpile custody; Oman certifies maritime posture; Switzerland certifies financial transfer. Two advisory channels (Pakistan, UN) provide political confirmation. The Gate is a verification window, not a delay — the Day-One exchange activates on Day 1 regardless of certification status. IAEA inventory and packaging occur Days 1–7; transit initiates Days 7–14. If verification is ambiguous, escalation pauses but Day-One trades already made are not reversed.

Facilitators may grant a 10-day Technical Extension for genuine shipping, sealing, routing, or inspection delays.

What happens if someone breaks the deal: Rollback is tiered, not collapse. A delay in one step does not disturb completed steps or already-released benefits. Minor technical issues get a 14-day fix with 96-hour Technical Grace Periods for non-material anomalies. Material breaches suspend discretionary relief but keep humanitarian channel, enrichment cap, and ceasefire hotline alive. Only deliberate hostile violations trigger full rollback. The custodial stockpile stays under IAEA control. The humanitarian corridor continues under UN mandate. The Framework Survival Core survives everything.

No precedent: This Framework establishes no legal or political precedent for future negotiations. Each provision is sui generis, tailored to the May 2026 crisis. No inference may be drawn about positions on any matter not expressly addressed. Neither side concedes its core demands for a comprehensive agreement.

Bottom line — both sides can claim victory:

Iran's Win	U.S. Win
Maritime enforcement posture eased on Day 1; ports open	60% enriched uranium leaves Iran on Day 1; verified by IAEA
Humanitarian funds released immediately; civilian aviation authorized	Enrichment capped at 3.67%; IAEA on Iranian soil daily
U.S. acknowledges sovereign nuclear rights under NPT Article IV	No new centrifuges at any facility including hardened sites
Material transferred to IAEA custody, not to the United States; sovereign title preserved	12-month verified compliance baseline creates 90+ day warning for any future breakout
12-month stabilization window, renewable; not permanent surrender	Every concession reciprocal and simultaneous; nothing given away

Neither side moves alone. Neither side surrenders. Both sides win on Day 1.

Annex H: Implementation Checklist for Facilitators

SIX-STEP SEQUENCE

This checklist provides a concise path through the Framework's implementation sequence. Facilitators should work through each step in order without re-reading the full draft.

- 1. Political Signature and Immediate Reciprocal Commitment (Day 1, 72-hour window):** Both Parties activate their Day-One commitments. Iran initiates stockpile transfer to IAEA custody. The U.S. releases \$250 million and eases maritime enforcement. The Joint Coordination Secretariat records activation and opens the Transparency Portal entry.
- 2. IAEA Inventory, Sealing, and Packaging Preparation (Days 1–7):** IAEA inspectors conduct physical inventory at Esfahan. Mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition. Cylinders are loaded into certified casks with tamper-evident seals. Chain-of-custody documentation is finalized. Staged batches are permitted if logistics require.
- 3. Transit Initiation and Batch Movement (Days 7–14):** Convoy departs under IAEA armed escort with GPS tracking. If multiple batches are used, each convoy has independent tracking and escort. The 72-hour Logistical Buffer is available for transit-initiation delays. All calibration or transit delays must be reported to the Secretariat within 24 hours.
- 4. Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate Certification (by Day 14, or shortly after with extension):** Three primary channels (IAEA, Oman, Switzerland) certify completion of Day-One commitments. The 10-day Technical Extension is available for genuine shipping, sealing, routing, or inspection delays. The Gate is verification only; it does not delay the underlying exchange.
- 5. Administrative Power-Down and Gate-Cleared Relief (Days 14–45):** Upon Gate certification, Iran begins the 7-day Administrative Power-Down (non-prejudicial to compliance). Tranche 2a (Day 14) releases: petrochemicals, oil services, civilian aviation. Tranche 2b (Day 45) releases: 25% of frozen assets upon IAEA confirmation of freeze completion.
- 6. Progressive Implementation and Monitoring (Days 45–180):** Remaining tranches release progressively (Days 60, 90, 120, 150, 180), each verified before the next. Monitoring technologies apply at graduated intensity. Sunset tiers reduce intrusive measures after 12, 18, and 24 months of clean compliance. Exploratory discussions on successor arrangements may begin at Month 9 without obligation.

Instruments of Acceptance

This Framework is offered for acceptance by signature and exchange of instruments through the Designated Facilitating States, or by exchange of diplomatic notes confirming intent to be bound. It enters into force upon the later of the two acceptances, for an initial period of twelve months, renewable annually by mutual written consent. Non-renewal does not constitute breach and does not retroactively invalidate obligations performed during operation.

For the United States of America:

Name:
Title:
Date:

For the Islamic Republic of Iran:

Name:
Title:
Date:

**Witnessed by the Sultanate of Oman
(Designated Facilitating State):**

Name:
Title:
Date:

**Witnessed by the Swiss Confederation
(Designated Facilitating State):**

Name:
Title:
Date:

Depositary

The original shall be deposited with the Secretary-General of the United Nations, who shall transmit certified copies to both Parties and all Designated Facilitating States.